

Procyon lotor

Northern raccoon



Location S. Canada to Central America

Length 17½–24 in (44–62 cm)

Tail 7½–14 in (19–36 cm)

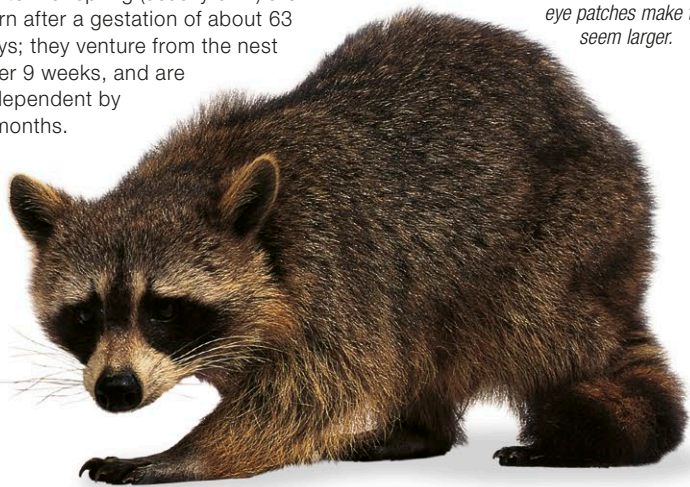
Weight 6–19 lb (2.7–10.4 kg)

Social unit Individual

Status Least concern



Bold and adaptable, with a generalized diet, the raccoon is familiar in many habitats from prairie and woodland to urban sprawl. Active day and night, and normally solitary, raccoons may gather in groups at plentiful food sources such as garbage dumps. Male and female come together briefly for mating with loud chirps and chitters. The female builds a breeding nest in any sheltered site, such as a tree hole, among rocks, or under an outbuilding. Up to 7 offspring (usually 3–4) are born after a gestation of about 63 days; they venture from the nest after 9 weeks, and are independent by 6 months.



MASKED BANDIT



The “bandit mask” of the Northern raccoon appears to reflect its opportunistic habits. It can climb, dig, and skillfully manipulate doors and latches with its forepaws, and is agile enough to gain access to many livestock enclosures. It may rub dirt off the food before eating it, or rinse it clean if there is water available nearby.

COLORATION

The northern raccoon’s long fur varies from pale gray to almost black. The tail has faint dark rings. The ears are short and rounded, and the eyes are small, although the black eye patches make them seem larger.

Procyon cancrivorus

Crab-eating raccoon



Location Central America to S. South America

Length 21½–30 in (54–76 cm)

Tail 10–15 in (25–38 cm)

Weight 6½–17½ lb (3.1–7.7 kg)

Social unit Individual

Status Least concern



Also called the mapache or osito lavador, this raccoon has short, coarse fur. By

brown or gray fur grizzled with black



black eye mask

Potos flavus

Kinkajou



Location S. Mexico to South America

Length 15½–30 in (39–76 cm)

Tail 15½–22½ in (39–57 cm)

Weight 3¼–10 lb (1.5–4.5 kg)

Social unit Individual

Status Least concern



The kinkajou boasts many local names, including mico de noche and martucha. It has a strongly prehensile tail and powerfully

grasping feet for great agility in trees. Primarily nocturnal and herbivorous, it also eats grubs, insects, and small vertebrates. The kinkajou makes varied sounds, including squeaks, whistles, grunts, moans, and barks, to proclaim territory, attract a mate, and warn of predators. The single young is born in a tree nest.

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woolly, buff-gold to gray fur

Red panda

PHYLUM	Chordata
CLASS	Mammalia
ORDER	Carnivora
FAMILY	Ailuridae
SPECIES	1

The red panda is a cat-sized mammal from the eastern Himalayas with a soft chestnut coat and bushy tail. It climbs well, but also spends time on the ground. The genetic position of this animal remains unresolved because of its morphology and diet. Several hypotheses exist, but research has only established that it is the sister group of bears. It lives at cooler, higher elevations than the giant panda and has a more omnivorous diet.

Tree climber

The red panda has partly retractable claws, and the forepaw of the panda has an elongated wrist bone like that of the giant panda, which is an adaptation for grasping bamboo. It uses trees not only for feeding but also to escape ground-based predators, and to sunbathe high in the canopy during winter. The female’s nest may be in a tree hole, lined with leaves, moss, and other soft plant material, where she rears her 1–5 (usually 2) offspring. Other nesting sites are branch forks, tree roots, and bamboo thickets.



Ailurus fulgens

Red panda



Location S. to S.E. Asia

Length 20–29 in (51–73 cm)

Tail 11–20 in (28–50 cm)

Weight 6½–13 lb (3–6 kg)

Social unit Individual

Status Vulnerable



In addition to bamboo leaves and shoots, the red panda eats other grasses, roots, fruit, and also grubs, small vertebrates such as mice and lizards, and birds’ eggs and chicks. It is mainly nocturnal

CHESTNUT COLORING

The red or “lesser” panda is red-brown or chestnut with almost white ear rims, cheeks, muzzle, and spots above the eyes. There are also brown, facial “teardrop” stripes.

and solitary, but forms pairs during the mating season, and offspring stay with their mother for up to a year. The panda scent marks its territory with droppings, urine, and powerful musklike secretions from the anal glands. It communicates by short whistles and squeaks. Studies in captivity show the gestation period is probably 90 days plus a variable time of delayed implantation. Prime habitats are dense temperate mountain forests, at 6,000–13,200 ft (1,800–4,000 m).



alternating light and dark rings on tail